

**CHARTER OF THE
STUDENTS' PARLIAMENT
OF IIIT HYDERABAD**

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PREAMBLE

We, the Students' Parliament of IIIT Hyderabad,

having been established as a democratically elected Student Body for the students, of the students, and by the students of this Institute,

having solemnly resolved to work towards the well-being and welfare of the students of this Institute to the best of our abilities,

having sworn to uphold the ideals and values of this Institute and the country of India in all the work we do,

on this fifteenth day of August, 2026, do hereby adopt, enact, and give ourselves this Charter.

PART I
GENERAL PROVISIONS

ARTICLE I
IDENTITY

Section 1. Name.

- (a) The formal name of this Student Body shall be the “Students’ Parliament” (hereinafter referred to as the “Parliament”).

Section 2. Logo.

- (a) The logo of the Students’ Parliament shall be the following.



PART II

STRUCTURE

ARTICLE I

COMPOSITION

Section 1. Definitions.

- (a) A Constituent who has been democratically elected to the Students' Parliament shall be defined as a Member of Parliament, holding full voting rights in Sessions of the Parliament and within their respective Councils.
- (b) A student appointed to a Council or Subcouncil to fill a seat that could not be filled by election, or to otherwise assist a Council or Subcouncil in its duties, shall be defined as a Nominated Member of a Council or Subcouncil. Nominated Members hold voting rights strictly within their assigned Council or Subcouncil and possess no vote in general Sessions of the Parliament.

Section 2. Elected Members.

- (a) Elected Members shall be part of the general Parliament and shall be appointed to Councils.
- (b) The General Secretary and Speaker shall be part of no Councils.
- (c) Each of the remaining elected Members of Parliament shall be part of no more than four Councils. Each Member shall choose three Councils to join.
- (d) If the requirements for the composition of a Council are not met, the General Secretary may assign Members to a fourth Council with their consent.

Section 3. Nominated Members.

- (a) Nominated Members may only be appointed to Councils or Subcouncils, to fulfil the minimum strength requirements prescribed for each Council.
- (b) The General Secretary shall announce the opening of nominations to Councils and Subcouncils if required.
- (c) The General Secretary, the Speaker, and the Members of the respective Council or Subcouncil shall interview all candidates for that Council or Subcouncil.

- (d) The Speaker shall provide the Members of the Council or Subcouncil with a ranked list of candidates based on suitability. The Council shall proceed down this list sequentially, evaluating candidates one by one. A candidate is appointed as a Nominated Member upon the passing of a Resolution of Appointment by the Council, failing which, the Council advances to the next ranked candidate.
- (e) The number of Nominated Members appointed to a Council shall not exceed one-half of the number of elected Members of Parliament appointed to that Council; however, this cap may be exceeded if and only if necessary to meet the composition requirements of Part IV.

ARTICLE II

TERMS OF OFFICE

Section 1. Duration.

- (a) The term of office of the Parliament, and of every Member thereof, shall last from the date of the announcement of the results of the General Election in which they were elected, to the date of the announcement of the results of the next General Election.
- (b) The term of office of the Parliament, and of every Member thereof, shall not last more than four hundred days in all.
- (c) The Election Commission must conduct a General Election as described in Part III before the term of the current Parliament elapses.

Section 2. Self-Extension.

- (a) The Parliament may only extend its term by no more than thirty days, provided there is no objection in writing from the Election Commission, and contingent upon a Resolution of Procedure.

ARTICLE III

COUNCILS

Section 1. Definitions.

- (a) A group within the Parliament comprising Members of Parliament mandated to address a specific domain of student life, well-being, and welfare, functioning in collaboration with the relevant Institute Committees, shall be defined as a Council.

- (b) A subdivision of a Council operating under the umbrella of its parent Council, focused on localized domains such as a specific hostel or mess, shall be defined as a Subcouncil.

Section 2. Quorum.

- (a) Every Council shall require the presence of no less than one-fourth of the number of voting Members, or three Members, whichever is higher, to constitute a quorum for the conduct of Council business.
- (b) Every Subcouncil shall require the presence of no less than one-half of the number of voting Members, or three Members, whichever is higher, to constitute a quorum for the conduct of Subcouncil business.

ARTICLE IV

PANELS

Section 1. Definitions.

- (a) A group formed by the Parliament, given specific terms of reference, and comprising Members of Parliament and, where necessary, students, shall be defined as a Panel. A Panel may invite staff or faculty to offer their inputs, answer questions, or act as observers.
- (b) A Panel shall be dissolved upon fulfilling its terms of reference, upon the expiry of the period stated in its terms of reference, or upon a Resolution of Procedure of the Parliament, whichever is earliest. Where no period is stated, the Panel shall be dissolved when the term of the Parliament that created it elapses.

Section 2. Quorum.

- (a) Every Panel shall require the presence of no less than one-fourth of the number of voting Members, or three Members, whichever is higher, to constitute a quorum for the conduct of Panel business.
- (b) Observers shall not be considered voting Members of a Panel.

ARTICLE V

LEADERSHIP POSITIONS

Section 1. Nature.

- (a) The Parliament recognizes no executive or cabinet hierarchy.

- (b) The nature of every position described in this Article is that of a Point of Contact and facilitator, possessing no authority beyond that expressly granted by this Charter.

Section 2. The General Secretary.

- (a) The General Secretary shall be the primary external Point of Contact and chief spokesperson of the Parliament to the Institute – including but not limited to the Director, the Registrar, the Deans, and the Institute Committee Chairs – and all external organizations.
- (b) The General Secretary shall communicate every passed Resolution to all Constituents via official channels of communication within two days of its passage. The General Secretary shall communicate the Resolution to the Institute via official channels of communication if necessary.
- (c) The General Secretary shall nominate Members of Parliament to serve as student representatives on Institute Committees, including the Disciplinary Committee, the Anti-Ragging Committee, the Gender Grievance Cell, and the Internal Complaints Committee, subject to their confirmation by a Resolution of Appointment passed by the Parliament. However, a Member of Parliament shall not serve as a student representative on more than two Institute Committees at the same time.
- (d) The General Secretary shall nominate students for extra-curricular initiatives or volunteer positions as and when requested by the Institute, subject to their confirmation by a Resolution of Appointment passed by the Parliament.
- (e) The General Secretary shall not hold any of the following positions.
 - (i) Apex Member,
 - (ii) Student Placement Coordinator,
 - (iii) Felicity Coordinator,
 - (iv) Secretary or Under Secretary of Clubs Council,
 - (v) Secretary or Deputy Secretary of Sports Council,
 - (vi) Secretary or Joint Secretary of Cultural Council,
 - (vii) Coordinator of Entrepreneurship Cell,
 - (viii) Coordinator of Student-Alumni Connect Cell,
 - (ix) Coordinator of National Service Scheme,
 - (x) Coordinator of Campus Life Council,
 - (xi) Speaker of the Students' Parliament, or
 - (xii) Secretary of a Council of the Students' Parliament.
- (f) Candidates for this position must resign from the position of Speaker or Council Secretary, if they hold such a position.

- (g) Candidates for this position must be elected Members of Parliament and not Nominated Members.
- (h) The General Secretary shall hold no voting rights within any individual Council.

Section 3. The Speaker.

- (a) The Speaker shall be the primary internal Point of Contact of the Parliament and chief administrative officer, responsible for the logistical facilitation of Sessions and the smooth functioning of the Councils.
- (b) The Speaker shall set the agenda for each Session, book venues, count and certify votes on every Resolution, and ensure the orderly conduct of the house.
- (c) The Speaker shall record the summary of every Session and details of every Resolution in the Parliamentary Archive, as provided for in Part VII, Article II.
- (d) The Speaker shall be empowered to form a Panel, appoint its Convener, provide it with its terms of reference, and select its Members, subject to confirmation by a Resolution of Appointment.
- (e) The Speaker shall not hold any of the following positions.
 - (i) Apex Member,
 - (ii) Student Placement Coordinator,
 - (iii) Felicity Coordinator,
 - (iv) Secretary or Under Secretary of Clubs Council,
 - (v) Secretary or Deputy Secretary of Sports Council,
 - (vi) Secretary or Joint Secretary of Cultural Council,
 - (vii) Coordinator of Entrepreneurship Cell,
 - (viii) Coordinator of Student-Alumni Connect Cell,
 - (ix) Coordinator of National Service Scheme,
 - (x) Coordinator of Campus Life Council,
 - (xi) General Secretary of the Students' Parliament, or
 - (xii) Secretary of a Council of the Students' Parliament.
- (f) Candidates for this position must resign from the position of General Secretary or Council Secretary, if they hold such a position.
- (g) Candidates for this position must be elected Members of Parliament and not Nominated Members.
- (h) The Speaker shall hold no voting rights within any individual Council, except for the purpose of breaking a tie.

Section 4. The Council Secretaries.

- (a) Each Council of the Students' Parliament shall have a Council Secretary, elected from amongst the Members of Parliament who are part of the Council.
- (b) The Council Secretary shall be the primary Point of Contact between their Council and the relevant offices and committees of the Institute.
- (c) The Council Secretary shall run their Council's meetings, delegate tasks among its Members, track progress on Council initiatives, and report on Council activity to the Parliament.
- (d) The Council Secretary shall record information related to the above in the Parliamentary Archive.
- (e) The Council Secretary shall not hold any of the following positions.
 - (i) Apex Member,
 - (ii) Student Placement Coordinator,
 - (iii) Felicity Coordinator,
 - (iv) Secretary or Under Secretary of Clubs Council,
 - (v) Secretary or Deputy Secretary of Sports Council,
 - (vi) Secretary or Joint Secretary of Cultural Council,
 - (vii) Coordinator of Entrepreneurship Cell,
 - (viii) Coordinator of Student-Alumni Connect Cell,
 - (ix) Coordinator of National Service Scheme,
 - (x) Coordinator of Campus Life Council,
 - (xi) Secretary of another Council of the Students' Parliament, or
 - (xii) General Secretary or Speaker of the Students' Parliament.
- (f) Candidates for this position must be elected Members of Parliament and not Nominated Members.
- (g) A Member of Parliament shall not be a candidate for the position of Council Secretary in more than one Council at the same time.

Section 5. The Conveners.

- (a) Each Panel of the Students' Parliament shall have a Convener, appointed by the Speaker from amongst the Members of the Panel.
- (b) The Convener shall be the primary Point of Contact between their Panel and the Parliament.
- (c) The Convener shall run their Panel's meetings, delegate tasks among its Members, ensure the terms of reference are followed, and report on Panel activity to the Parliament.
- (d) The Convener shall record information related to the above in the Parliamentary Archive.
- (e) If the terms of reference of a Panel are in the domain of a Council, the Convener shall keep the Council Secretary of that Council informed of the Panel's proceedings, and the Panel shall seek the views of that Council before reporting to the Parliament. A disagreement

between a Convener and a Council Secretary as to the scope of a Panel's terms of reference shall be settled by the Parliament by a Resolution of Procedure.

- (f) The Convener shall not hold any of the following positions.
 - (i) General Secretary of the Students' Parliament,
 - (ii) Speaker of the Students' Parliament, or
 - (iii) Convener of another Panel of the Students' Parliament.

PART III

ELECTIONS

ARTICLE I

THE ELECTION COMMISSION

Section 1. Independence and Supremacy.

- (a) The Election Commission is recognized as an independent Student Body, external to the Parliament.
- (b) The Election Commission is supreme in all matters relating to the conduct of elections, subject to the provisions of this Charter, and no person or entity shall interfere in its operations.

ARTICLE II

GENERAL ELECTIONS

Section 1. Method and Eligibility.

- (a) General Elections to the Parliament shall be conducted by the Election Commission by secret ballot, using the ranked-choice electoral method known as the Single Transferable Vote.
- (b) Candidates for a General Election must be Constituents as defined in Part IX, Article I.
- (c) A Constituent shall be eligible to contest a General Election provided that, at the time of nomination, they are not barred by the Institute from holding a Position of Responsibility, and they are not a member of the Election Commission.

Section 2. Seats.

- (a) The overall strength of the Parliament shall be determined at a ratio of one elected representative for every fifty Constituents in the student population. The number of seats shall be rounded up.
- (b) No seat shall be filled without an election. If the number of candidates is insufficient to fill all seats at a General Election, the remaining seats shall remain vacant upon the conclusion of that election.
- (c) If fewer than one-half of the Constituents in a particular Constituency vote in the General Election, the number of seats for that

Constituency shall be reduced as per the formula $n' = \max(\lfloor 2nx \rfloor, 1)$, where n' is the final number of seats, n is the original number of seats, x is the proportion of Constituents in that Constituency who voted in the General Election, expressed as a decimal, $\max(a, b)$ returns the greater of a and b , and $\lfloor k \rfloor$ denotes the greatest integer less than or equal to k .

Section 3. Reservation.

- (a) In every Constituency, a minimum of one-fourth of its final number of seats is reserved for women and gender-diverse Constituents (as per their Institute-registered gender), to ensure equitable representation. This number is rounded up to the nearest whole seat, except in a single-seat Constituency, which reserves no seat. If the number of eligible candidates is less than the number of reserved seats, the remainder of the reserved seats shall remain vacant.
- (b) The reservation takes effect only when the number of eligible candidates who win seats on the ordinary vote count is fewer than the number of reserved seats. If eligible candidates already win at least that many seats on their own, the reservation has no effect and no seats are set aside or reassigned. When the reservation takes effect, the lowest-ranked non-eligible winners are replaced by the highest-ranked non-elected eligible candidates, until all reserved seats are filled or no further eligible candidates remain.

ARTICLE III

ELECTIONS FOR GENERAL SECRETARY AND SPEAKER

Section 1. Conduct and Timelines.

- (a) Internal elections for the offices of General Secretary and Speaker shall be conducted by the Election Commission from amongst the elected Members of Parliament.
- (b) The General Secretary and Speaker shall be elected by the Members of Parliament via a secret ballot conducted by the Election Commission. Amongst the standing candidates for each respective position, the candidate securing the highest number of votes shall be declared the winner.
- (c) The election shall take place only if no less than one-half of the elected Members of Parliament are present.
- (d) The option of voting for “None of the above” shall be provided.
- (e) These elections shall be concluded within fifteen days of the announcement of the results of the General Election.

Section 2. Failure to Elect.

- (a) A Leadership Election shall be deemed to have failed to produce a General Secretary or a Speaker if, for that position, no candidate stands for election, or the quorum under Part III, Article III, Section 1 is not met.
- (b) When a Leadership Election fails to produce a General Secretary or a Speaker within the prescribed timeline, the Election Commission shall have seven days within which to conduct a fresh Leadership Election for the position or positions that remain unfilled. A position already filled shall not be re-contested.
- (c) If this fresh election also fails to produce a General Secretary or a Speaker, the Parliament shall be deemed dissolved with immediate effect. Upon such dissolution, the Chief Election Commissioner shall assume the office of Statutory Caretaker, holding custody of official communications but exercising no power, and the Election Commission shall conduct fresh General Elections within fifteen days.

ARTICLE IV**ELECTIONS FOR COUNCIL SECRETARY****Section 1. Conduct and Timelines.**

- (a) The General Secretary shall suggest a Member of the Council as a candidate for the position of Council Secretary – preference shall be given to a candidate who has been a Member of that specific Council for at least one term.
- (b) The Council must pass a Resolution of Appointment to appoint a candidate to the position of Council Secretary.
- (c) This process shall be concluded within fifteen days of the announcement of the results of the Election of the General Secretary and Speaker.

Section 2. Failure to Elect.

- (a) When the Council fails to pass a Resolution of Appointment within the timeline prescribed by Part III, Article IV, Section 1, an internal election shall be conducted by the Speaker.
- (b) Any Member of Parliament appointed to the Council may become a candidate for the position of Council Secretary by writing to the Speaker within a stipulated nomination period, which shall be reasonable and shall not exceed seven days. The Speaker must then communicate the names of the candidates to the Council at the end of that time period.

- (c) The Members of the Council must vote for a candidate via a secret ballot conducted by the Speaker, no less than one day and no more than three days after the candidates are communicated to the Council.
- (d) Amongst the standing candidates for this position, the candidate securing the highest number of votes shall be declared the winner.
- (e) The counting of votes by the Speaker must be done in the presence of the Members of the Council.
- (f) If this election also fails to fill the position of Council Secretary, the candidate suggested by the General Secretary shall be appointed to the position of Council Secretary.
- (g) This process shall be concluded within thirty days of the announcement of the results of the Election of the General Secretary and Speaker.

ARTICLE V PROCEDURES

Section 1. Oath Taking.

- (a) The elected representatives must take their Oaths as set out in Part IX, Article II, as part of an Oath Taking Ceremony that shall take place within fifteen days of the election of all Council Secretaries.
- (b) Members of Parliament shall take the Oaths of Office and Secrecy. The General Secretary, Speaker, and Council Secretaries shall take the Oaths of Office, Secrecy, and Leadership.

Section 2. Announcement of Composition.

- (a) The Students' Parliament shall announce the following in writing, via official channels of communication, to all students as well as to the Institute, before the Oath Taking Ceremony.
 - (i) The names and Constituencies of elected Members of Parliament and Nominated Members.
 - (ii) The names of the General Secretary, Speaker, and Council Secretaries.
 - (iii) The names of each Council and Subcouncil, and the scope of their work, as defined in Part IV.
 - (iv) The names and Constituencies of Members of each Council and Subcouncil.

PART IV

COUNCILS

The Councils shall mirror one or more Institute Committees, working closely with these Committees and the relevant faculty and staff.

ARTICLE I

ACADEMIC COUNCIL

Section 1. Composition.

- (a) The Academic Council shall consist of no less than eight Members, comprising one first-year undergraduate student, one second-year undergraduate student, one third-year undergraduate student, one fourth-year undergraduate student, one first-year postgraduate student, one second-year postgraduate student, one student in the MS by Research programme, and one student in the PhD programme.

Section 2. Powers and Responsibilities.

- (a) The Council shall take up matters concerning the academic activities of students, including but not limited to academic policies, academic procedures, courses, teaching assistantships, curriculum, internships, and placements.
- (b) The Council shall review and provide suggestions on the academic almanac for subsequent semesters.
- (c) The Council shall participate in discussions with the Dean of Academics and relevant faculty regarding the introduction or modification of academic policies, and work to ensure all policy documents are accessible and up-to-date.

ARTICLE II

RESEARCH COUNCIL

Section 1. Composition.

- (a) The Research Council shall consist of no less than seven Members, comprising one third-year undergraduate student, one fourth-year

undergraduate student, one fifth-year dual-degree undergraduate student, two students in the MS by Research programme, and two students in the PhD programme. The third-year and fourth-year undergraduate students must be dual-degree students, or be enrolled in the Honours programme.

Section 2. Powers and Responsibilities.

- (a) The Council shall take up matters concerning the research activities of students, including but not limited to issues faced by research scholars, thesis requirements, graduation criteria, stipend disbursements, and research infrastructure.
- (b) The Council shall assist students in adversarial situations arising in matters related to their advisors or co-advisors.
- (c) The Council shall participate in discussions with the Dean of Research and Development, the PG Cell, the PG Chair, and relevant faculty regarding the introduction or modification of relevant policies, and work to ensure all policy documents are accessible and up-to-date.

ARTICLE III HEALTH COUNCIL

Section 1. Composition.

- (a) The Health Council shall consist of no less than six Members, of whom two shall be men, two shall be women, one shall be of a gender-diverse identity (as per their Institute-registered gender), and one shall be a Well-being Volunteer.

Section 2. Powers and Responsibilities.

- (a) The Council shall take up matters related to the physical and mental health and well-being of students, including but not limited to helping the Campus Health and Medical Committee in handling student grievances regarding the campus clinic, doctors, nurses, counsellors, and other healthcare professionals, and suggesting improvements to the memoranda of understanding.
- (b) The Council shall coordinate with the Campus Health and Medical Committee to manage any disease outbreaks, and help students who need to quarantine or self-isolate if necessary.
- (c) The Council shall work with the Counselling and Wellness Cell in matters related to the mental well-being of students and the wider community.

ARTICLE IV

HOSTEL COUNCIL

Section 1. Composition.

- (a) The Hostel Council shall be organized into Subcouncils corresponding to the respective hostels on campus, each consisting of no less than six Members, of whom no less than two must be Members of Parliament.
- (b) Each Subcouncil must include no less than one Member from each year residing in that particular hostel.

Section 2. Powers and Responsibilities.

- (a) The Council shall work with the Hostel Incharges, Hostel Wardens, and the Chair of the Council of Wardens on matters related to student life in the hostel.
- (b) The Council shall review the income and expenditure of the hostels every semester with the Chair of the Council of Wardens, and provide inputs on managing the same for the subsequent semesters.
- (c) Each Subcouncil of the Hostel Council shall work with the respective Hostel Incharge to allocate rooms and roommates, as and when needed.
- (d) Each hostel shall be allocated a budget for the purpose of making small repairs and purchases, which the respective Hostel Subcouncil shall administer with the approval of the respective Hostel Warden.

ARTICLE V

MESS COUNCIL

Section 1. Composition.

- (a) The Mess Council shall be organized into Subcouncils corresponding to the respective messes on campus, each consisting of no less than six Members, of whom no less than two must be Members of Parliament. Each Subcouncil must also have one Campus Dining Portal Administrator to assist with any Portal-related matters.
- (b) Each Subcouncil shall include Members who are familiar with the respective cuisine of each mess.

Section 2. Powers and Responsibilities.

- (a) Each Subcouncil of the Mess Council shall work with the vendors managing the messes, and the Campus Dining Services, to decide menus, conduct inspections and food tastings, and recommend imposing fines on vendors for violations of their contracts.
- (b) Each Subcouncil shall have weekly meetings with the vendors, scheduled by the Campus Dining Services, to discuss feedback and issues reported by students in that week.
- (c) Each Subcouncil shall ensure inclusion of a diversity of cuisines and accommodate student requests to the best of its ability.
- (d) The Council shall review, every year and together with the Chair of the Campus Dining Services Committee, the contracts with the vendors as well as the income and expenditure of the Campus Dining Services, and shall provide inputs on matters related to mess rates, operations, and infrastructure.
- (e) Members of the Council shall be a part of any Committee set up to select a vendor for cooking the food, and shall constitute no less than one-fourth of that Committee.
- (f) The Council shall be allocated a reasonable budget to send food samples for testing as and when needed.

ARTICLE VI STALL COUNCIL

Section 1. Composition.

- (a) The Stall Council shall have a minimum strength equal to the number of stalls on campus, or five Members, whichever is higher.
- (b) Each stall shall have one Member of the Stall Council as a Point of Contact.

Section 2. Powers and Responsibilities.

- (a) The Council shall be solely responsible for managing menus, reviewing and approving stall timings and closures, inviting and reviewing proposals for new stalls, and suggesting the removal of an existing stall.
- (b) The Council shall review prices, monitor hygiene, and address concerns regarding campus vendors in coordination with the Campus Facilities and Services, the Campus Dining Services, and the Campus Dining Services Committee.

ARTICLE VII
INFRASTRUCTURE COUNCIL

Section 1. Composition.

- (a) The Infrastructure Council shall maintain an open composition of Members, with a minimum strength of five Members.

Section 2. Powers and Responsibilities.

- (a) The Council shall work with the relevant Institute authorities on matters of common public physical and technological infrastructure, including but not limited to classrooms, workspaces, libraries, public washrooms, street lighting, biometric infrastructure, closed-circuit television cameras, campus networks, and Institute portals and digital services.
- (b) The Council shall work with Campus Facilities and Services, the Campus Maintenance and Repairs team, the Institute Facilities and Services Committee, the Campus Services and Beautification Committee, and the Water Monitoring Committee to resolve infrastructural issues.
- (c) The Council shall work with the Security Committee to address matters related to campus security.
- (d) The Council shall work with system administrators, web administrators, the IT Office, the Information Security Committee, the Chief Information Security Officer, and the Technical Resource Committee to address matters related to technological infrastructure.

PART V
POWERS AND RESPONSIBILITIES

ARTICLE I
POWERS

Section 1. Statutory Powers.

- (a) The Students' Parliament is empowered to make formal recommendations to the Institute on any matters related to student well-being and welfare, academics, research, campus infrastructure, and campus life by passing a Resolution of Address.
- (b) The Students' Parliament is empowered to draft policies and present them to the Institute for approval on any matters related to student welfare, academics, research, campus infrastructure, and campus life.
- (c) The Students' Parliament may request, in writing, information or action of any kind from the Institute, and shall expect a written response within a reasonably stipulated time period, not exceeding seven days.
- (d) The Students' Parliament may request, in writing, information or action of any kind from any Student Body, Club, or Special Interest Group, and shall expect a written response within a reasonably stipulated time period, not exceeding seven days.
- (e) The Students' Parliament may request, in writing, a response from a student on any matter. The student may choose not to respond; however, they must inform the Students' Parliament of the same.

ARTICLE II
RESPONSIBILITIES

Section 1. Duties of the Members.

- (a) Every Member of Parliament must hold office hours, accessible to all Constituents, at least once every fifteen days, and must announce the same in advance via an official channel of communication.
- (b) Members of Parliament and Nominated Members shall actively advocate for student interests, welfare, and rights, and shall proactively take up issues brought forward by Constituents.

- (c) Members of Parliament and Nominated Members must uphold the highest level of academic integrity and abide by all the lawful rules and regulations of the Institute.
- (d) A Member of Parliament or Nominated Member shall consider – with respect to every matter before the Parliament – whether it concerns them particularly rather than as one of a class of Constituents, Student Bodies, Clubs, or Special Interest Groups affected by it, and shall declare any such interest to the Parliament before it deliberates upon the matter. A Member who has declared an interest shall count towards the quorum, may speak upon the matter, and may be questioned upon it, but shall recuse themselves from voting upon it.
- (e) A Member of Parliament or Nominated Member must recuse themselves from any position, and from deliberation or voting on related matters, if they are the subject of pending or ongoing enquiries involving their conduct vis-à-vis other students. These enquiries include, but are not limited to, gender-related complaints filed against a Member, or complaints filed against a Member involving allegations of misconduct while holding a Position of Responsibility.
- (f) A Member who becomes unable to discharge the duties of their office or to represent their Constituents as prescribed by this Charter shall submit their resignation as per the provisions of Part VI, Article IV.

Section 2. Duties of the Parliament as a Whole.

- (a) The Students' Parliament shall regularly release a Parliament Activities Report documenting the activities and progress of the Parliament and its Councils, no less than twice each term.
- (b) The Students' Parliament shall provide a formal response to any written communication or petition received from a Constituent within a reasonably stipulated time period, not exceeding seven days. An initial response or acknowledgement must be sent within three days of receiving the communication.

PART VI
PARLIAMENTARY PROCEDURES

ARTICLE I
SESSIONS OF PARLIAMENT

Section 1. Convening.

- (a) A formally convened meeting of the Parliament or a Council where official business is conducted and recorded shall be defined as a Session.
- (b) A Session of Parliament shall be convened by the Speaker no less than once every thirty days.
- (c) A special Session may be convened by the Speaker at the request of a Council Secretary or at the request of no less than one-fourth of the Members of Parliament.
- (d) The Speaker shall decide on a time and venue that is reasonably convenient for all Members.
- (e) The Speaker shall add an item to the agenda of the Session if suggested by a Member of Parliament.

Section 2. Quorum and Transparency.

- (a) The minimum number of voting Members who must be present at a Session to conduct business or pass a Resolution shall be defined as the Quorum.
- (b) The Quorum for a general Session of the full Parliament shall be one-fourth of the total number of Members of Parliament. This number shall be rounded up.
- (c) No Resolutions of Amendment or Resolutions of Censure shall be put to vote at a Session attended by fewer than one-half of the total number of Members of Parliament.
- (d) The Students' Parliament must share the list of attendees and a summary of the Session via official channels of communication, no more than two days after the Session has concluded. The summary shall not contain any personal or confidential information.
- (e) Following every Session, the Members in attendance must answer questions from Constituents for no less than fifteen minutes.

ARTICLE II

RESOLUTIONS

Section 1. Definition.

- (a) A formal expression of opinion, will, intent, or action passed by the Parliament or a Council shall be defined as a Resolution, and shall carry the full weight of the Students' Parliament.

Section 2. Categories.

- (a) A Resolution of Address, being an expression of the opinion, position, request, objection, or commendation of the Parliament and addressed to a particular entity or to the Constituents generally, shall require a simple majority of the votes cast to pass.
- (b) A Resolution of Appointment, making or confirming an appointment to an internal position, a nomination to an Institute Committee, or the creation of a Panel, shall require a simple majority of the votes cast to pass.
- (c) A Resolution of Procedure, governing the conduct of a Session, extending a timeline, or determining a question of procedure or of the interpretation of this Charter, shall require a simple majority of the votes cast to pass.
- (d) A Resolution of Censure, formally reprimanding a Member, Council, Subcouncil, or Panel for misconduct or failure of duty, shall require a simple majority of the votes cast to pass.
- (e) A Resolution of Amendment, altering the text of this Charter, shall be subject to Part VIII, Article I and shall require a three-fourths majority of the votes cast to pass.

ARTICLE III

VOTING

Section 1. Voting Procedures.

- (a) A vote may be called on any matter by any Member and must be seconded by another Member.
- (b) A vote shall take place only if a quorum is established.
- (c) Every vote taken to pass a Resolution may be conducted by a show of hands, by roll call, or by secret ballot, in an offline or online manner,

at the discretion of the Speaker, unless otherwise required by this Charter.

- (d) The Speaker shall mandate a vote by secret ballot if requested, before the commencement of voting, by no less than three voting Members.
- (e) The Speaker shall announce the matter put to vote in the required detail for Members of Parliament to make an informed decision. Members of Parliament shall only vote for the specified options.
- (f) The Speaker shall require every Member present to record a vote, save that no Member recused under Part V, Article II, Section 1 may be required to do so.
- (g) The Speaker may provide Members present with the option to cast a vote of abstention.
- (h) The counting of votes by the Speaker must be done in the presence of the voters, who may request a re-count if they have reason to believe there may have been a mistake in counting the votes.

ARTICLE IV

RESIGNATION

Section 1. Procedure.

- (a) A Member of Parliament or Nominated Member may resign from any Leadership Position as defined in Part II, Article V or from the Students' Parliament at any time by submitting written notice to the Speaker and General Secretary, with a copy provided to the Election Commission in the case of an elected Member. In the event of the resignation of the General Secretary or Speaker, the written notice shall be submitted to the Parliament, with a copy provided to the Election Commission.
- (b) In the event of the resignation of the General Secretary or the Speaker, the Election Commission must hold a fresh Leadership Election as per the provisions of Part III, Article III.
- (c) In the event of the resignation of a Council Secretary, a new appointment must be made as per the provisions of Part III, Article IV.
- (d) Such resignation shall take effect upon formal acceptance by the Speaker or within seven days of submission, whichever is earlier; and such acceptance shall not be unreasonably withheld or delayed. In the event of the resignation of the General Secretary or the Speaker, the resignation is automatically accepted.
- (e) A Member of Parliament who misses three consecutive office hours required of them under Part V, Article II, Section 1, or a Member

of Parliament or Nominated Member who misses three consecutive Sessions of the Parliament or of their Council, without providing a valid and truthful reason in writing to the Speaker, shall be deemed to have automatically resigned with immediate effect. The Speaker shall communicate the determination and its reasons to the Member in writing, and the Member may raise a grievance against the determination under Part VI, Article VI, during which the Member's seat shall not be filled.

ARTICLE V DISMISSAL

Section 1. Dismissal from the Position of General Secretary or Speaker.

- (a) A motion for the dismissal of the General Secretary or Speaker may be introduced by no less than one-fourth of the Members of Parliament, in writing to the Election Commission, on the grounds of failure to uphold duties, misconduct, or violation of the Charter.
- (b) A special Session must be called by the Election Commission for each and every such motion. The Election Commission shall provide notice to all Members of Parliament no less than two days before the Session at which the matter is to be heard. This Session must be held within seven days of the motion being raised.
- (c) The Session must be attended by no less than one-half of the Members of Parliament.
- (d) At that Session, and immediately before any vote is taken, the subject of the motion shall be entitled to exactly fifteen minutes of uninterrupted time to present their defence to the Parliament, followed by no less than fifteen minutes of discussion on the matter.
- (e) The question of dismissal shall thereafter be put to a vote by secret ballot, conducted by the Election Commission. The vote succeeds if a simple majority of the Members present vote in favour of dismissal.
- (f) If the vote succeeds, the Member holding the position is considered dismissed with immediate effect. The Election Commission must then hold a fresh Leadership Election as per the provisions of Part III, Article III.

Section 2. Dismissal from the Position of Council Secretary.

- (a) A motion for the dismissal of the Council Secretary may be introduced by no less than one-fourth of the Members of the respective

Council, in writing to the Speaker, on the grounds of failure to uphold duties, misconduct, or violation of the Charter.

- (b) A special Session must be called by the Speaker for each and every such motion. The Speaker shall provide notice to all Members of the respective Council no less than two days before the Session at which the matter is to be heard. This Session must be held within seven days of the motion being raised.
- (c) The Session must be attended by no less than one-half of the Members of the respective Council. Only voting Members of the respective Council shall vote on this motion.
- (d) At that Session, and immediately before any vote is taken, the subject of the motion shall be entitled to no less than ten minutes of uninterrupted time to present their defence to the Council.
- (e) The question of dismissal shall thereafter be put to a vote by secret ballot, conducted by the Speaker. The vote succeeds if a simple majority of the Members present vote in favour of dismissal.
- (f) If the vote succeeds, the Member holding the position is considered dismissed with immediate effect. A new appointment must be made as per the provisions of Part III, Article IV.

Section 3. Dismissal of a Member of Parliament.

- (a) In the event of disciplinary action wherein a sitting Member of Parliament or Nominated Member is barred from holding Positions of Responsibility, they shall be removed from their positions. The Director or Dean of Student Affairs must write to the Speaker informing them of the disciplinary action and requesting the immediate removal of the Member.

ARTICLE VI

GRIEVANCES

Section 1. Raising a Grievance.

- (a) A grievance may be raised by any Member of Parliament or Nominated Member who
 - (i) is dissatisfied with the conduct of proceedings in Parliament,
 - (ii) is dissatisfied with a procedural decision, action, or omission of any body or leadership of Parliament, or
 - (iii) believes that such conduct, decision, action, or omission is contrary to this Charter or to the rules of procedure.

- (b) A grievance shall be raised in writing and shall state the matter complained of, the provision, rule, or principle alleged to be violated where applicable, and the redress sought.

Section 2. Escalation.

- (a) A grievance shall first be submitted in writing to the General Secretary. The General Secretary shall respond in writing within seven days of receiving the grievance.
- (b) If the General Secretary does not respond within seven days, or if the Member is dissatisfied with the response, the Member may bring the grievance before Parliament. Parliament shall consider the grievance at its next Session and shall record its decision in writing.
- (c) If Parliament does not act in the next Session, or if the Member is dissatisfied with its decision, the Member may refer the grievance to the Dean of Student Affairs.
- (d) Where a grievance concerns the conduct of the General Secretary, or a matter in which the General Secretary has a personal interest, it may be brought directly before Parliament.

ARTICLE VII ACCOUNTABILITY

Section 1. Initiation.

- (a) Five or more Constituents may initiate either of the following proceedings:
 - (i) a No Confidence Motion – whether the Members of Parliament elected by a particular Constituency shall vacate their seats, or whether the Parliament as a whole shall be dissolved, and fresh elections held – or
 - (ii) a Constituents’ Motion – a direction to the Parliament to take, or to refrain from, a specified action.
- (b) In this Article, the affected Constituents are the Constituents of the Constituency concerned, where a No Confidence Motion relates to the Members elected by a particular Constituency, and all Constituents in every other case. Those initiating a proceeding shall be drawn from the affected Constituents.
- (c) Those initiating a proceeding shall deliver to the Election Commission a petition in writing, stating the grounds relied upon – including but not limited to the passage of a Resolution not supported by the affected Constituents, or non-compliance with the provisions of this

Charter – and, in the case of a Constituents’ Motion, the exact direction sought. A copy shall be delivered to the Parliament.

- (d) The Election Commission shall announce the Motion to the affected Constituents and shall collect signatures over a window of twenty-one days from the announcement, verifying each against the roll of Constituents.
- (e) A Constituent who has signed may withdraw their signature in writing at any time before the signature window closes.
- (f) Within seven days of the close of the signature window, the Election Commission shall certify the petition if it carries the signatures of no less than one-tenth of the affected Constituents, or no less than one-fifth of them when the Motion relates to the Members elected by a particular Constituency. The Election Commission shall otherwise reject the petition. The Election Commission shall give notice of the certification or rejection in writing to the affected Constituents.
- (g) No proceeding shall be initiated on substantially the same grounds within sixty days of a defeated Motion. The Election Commission shall determine any question as to whether the grounds are substantially the same.

Section 2. Limits.

- (a) A Constituents’ Motion may direct the Parliament to rescind a specified Resolution, to take or refrain from a specified action within the powers conferred upon it by Part V, Article I, to remove a Member, or to constitute a Panel with specified terms of reference.
- (b) A Constituents’ Motion shall not amend this Charter, direct the exercise of a power the Parliament does not possess, or direct any action contrary to this Charter, to the rules of the Institute, or to the law.
- (c) If a proposed direction falls outside these limits, the Election Commission shall allow those initiating the proceeding seven days to amend it, and shall otherwise reject the petition, stating its reasons in writing.

Section 3. Proceedings.

- (a) The Election Commission shall convene a meeting between the affected Constituents and the Parliament, at a reasonably convenient time within fifteen days of certifying the petition, and shall preside over it.
- (b) Those initiating the proceeding shall have fifteen minutes of uninterrupted time in which to make their case, and the Parliament shall

- then have fifteen minutes of uninterrupted time in which to answer it. There shall follow no more than one hour of questions and discussion.
- (c) The Election Commission shall publish a summary of the meeting before voting opens.
 - (d) Voting shall open no less than one day and no more than three days after the meeting concludes, shall remain open for no less than two days, and shall be conducted by the Election Commission by secret ballot among the affected Constituents.
 - (e) The question put upon the ballot for a No Confidence Motion shall be, and shall be only, whether the Members of Parliament elected by that Constituency shall vacate their seats, or whether the Parliament shall be dissolved, as the case may be, and fresh elections held. No other question shall appear upon that ballot.
 - (f) A Motion passes only when a majority of the votes cast are in favour, and the votes cast are no less than one-half of the affected Constituents. If either condition is not met, the question is defeated and the proceedings stand concluded.

Section 4. Effect.

- (a) If a No Confidence Motion relating to the Parliament as a whole passes, the Parliament dissolves with immediate effect. The Chief Election Commissioner shall assume the office of Statutory Caretaker, holding custody of official communications but exercising no power, and the Election Commission shall conduct fresh General Elections, as per the provisions of Part III, Article II, within thirty days.
- (b) If a No Confidence Motion relating to the Members elected by a particular Constituency passes, those Members vacate their seats with immediate effect, and the Election Commission shall conduct a fresh election in that Constituency within thirty days. The Parliament continues in office, and shall pass no Resolution of Amendment until the seats are filled.
- (c) A Member who has vacated a seat under this Section, or whose seat has fallen vacant upon a dissolution, is eligible to contest the ensuing election. Resolutions passed before a dissolution or vacation remain in force unless separately rescinded.
- (d) Where a Constituents' Motion passes, the Parliament shall comply with it and announce its compliance to the affected Constituents within the time stipulated by the Motion, or within thirty days where the Motion stipulates none. Failure to do so is grounds for a No Confidence Motion.

PART VII

COMMUNICATION AND ARCHIVES

ARTICLE I

OFFICIAL ACCOUNTS

The credentials for all accounts must be transferred to the new leadership within seven days of the announcement of the results of the respective leadership election.

Section 1. Electronic Mail.

- (a) The Students' Parliament as a whole shall make use of the e-mail address `parliament@students.iiit.ac.in` to send and receive official correspondence. This account shall be managed by the General Secretary, with the credentials known to the Speaker.
- (b) The General Secretary alone shall make use of the e-mail address `gensec@students.iiit.ac.in` to send and receive official correspondence. Similarly, the Speaker alone shall make use of the e-mail address `speaker@students.iiit.ac.in`.
- (c) Official communication domains and accounts shall be mapped to specific Councils as follows, to be managed by the respective Council Secretaries, with the credentials known to the General Secretary and the Speaker.

Council Name	E-Mail Address
Academic Council	<code>academic.council@students.iiit.ac.in</code>
Research Council	<code>research.council@students.iiit.ac.in</code>
Health Council	<code>health.council@students.iiit.ac.in</code>
Hostel Council	<code>hostel.council@students.iiit.ac.in</code>
Mess Council	<code>mess.council@students.iiit.ac.in</code>
Stall Council	<code>stall.council@students.iiit.ac.in</code>
Infrastructure Council	<code>infrastructure.council@students.iiit.ac.in</code>

Section 2. Other Applications.

- (a) The role accounts associated with the official e-mail addresses of the Students' Parliament and its Councils may be used on other platforms such as Discourse and Matrix. These accounts shall also be

managed by the General Secretary or the respective Council Secretaries.

ARTICLE II THE ARCHIVE

Section 1. Maintenance.

- (a) The Parliamentary Archive is the persistent, Institute-hosted digital repository of record maintained for the Parliament, and shall contain, including but not limited to, the summary of every Session, every Resolution raised, and all documents received or written by the Parliament, its Councils, or its Panels.
- (b) The Archive shall be regularly updated by all Members of Parliament.

ARTICLE III PROCEDURES

Section 1. Access.

- (a) Correspondence sent from or received at an official account forms part of the record of the Parliament. The Parliament, and the Council to which the account is mapped, may inspect it at any time; and no Member shall delete or withhold correspondence so as to defeat that inspection.

Section 2. Correspondence.

- (a) Before correspondence addressed to the Constituents generally, or to any list or body of them, is sent, the Member proposing to send it shall circulate its text to their Council or the Parliament and shall allow a reasonable opportunity for objection, being not less than two hours where circumstances permit. Corrections proposed by Members shall be made before the correspondence is sent.
- (b) The preceding clause does not apply to a routine notice of fact, nor to correspondence addressed to a particular person or office where the substance of the reply is plain; but a Member may circulate any such correspondence under that clause if in doubt.
- (c) If a message must be sent at once for the proper functioning of the Parliament, a Council, or the Institute, it may be sent without prior circulation. The Member who sends it shall thereafter share its text

and the circumstances requiring its urgency with their Council or the Parliament, and with the General Secretary and the Speaker, within one day.

- (d) Correspondence received at an official account of a Council shall be shared with the Members of the Council to which the account is mapped. In case it is received at an official account of the Parliament, it shall be shared with the Members of Parliament.
- (e) If the correspondence contains personal or confidential information that may not be suitable to share with the Council or the Parliament, the Member receiving it shall share it with the General Secretary or the Speaker. If the General Secretary or the Speaker receives such correspondence, they shall share the number of such items of correspondence received, if not their contents.

Section 3. Attribution.

- (a) Correspondence shall be sent in the name of the Parliament or of a Council, and shall not ordinarily state the name of the Member sending it. Correspondence is an act of the Parliament or of a Council, and not of the Member who sends it.
- (b) A Member may state their name where it is necessary to transact the business in hand, or where the recipient requires it.
- (c) No Member shall undersign correspondence with the title of a Member of Parliament, or of any Leadership Position they hold, unless the same is approved by the Parliament; and in the case of correspondence not circulated as per the provisions of Part VII, Article III, Section 2, the approval of the General Secretary, or of the Speaker, suffices.

PART VIII

AMENDMENTS AND RATIFICATION

ARTICLE I

AMENDMENTS

Section 1. Periodic Review.

- (a) The provisions of this Charter shall be formally reviewed by the Parliament once every term, preferably during the final Session of that term, to ensure their continued relevance and efficacy.

Section 2. Procedure.

- (a) An amendment to any part of this Charter, including the Preamble and Appendix, may be introduced by any Member of Parliament, and must be supported by no less than one-fourth of the Members of Parliament.
- (b) The proposed amendment shall be discussed at length in a formally convened Session of the Parliament before being put to a vote.
- (c) The text of a proposed Resolution of Amendment shall be circulated in writing to all Members of Parliament, and published to all Constituents, no less than seven days before the Session at which it is to be voted upon. No amendment shall be voted upon in a form materially different from the text so circulated.
- (d) An amendment shall come into effect only once a Resolution of Amendment is passed by the Parliament.
- (e) Any amendment that alters an existing statutory obligation of the Institute toward the Parliament under Part V, Article I, including response timelines, shall not take effect unless approved in writing by the Dean of Student Affairs or the Director.
- (f) No amendment shall be permitted that alters the fundamental democratic structure of this Charter.

ARTICLE II

RATIFICATION

Section 1. Enactment.

- (a) This Charter shall come into effect for the next term of the Parliament upon its adoption by the Students' Parliament through
 - (i) a vote in which no less than three-fourths of the total number of Members of Parliament support the adoption of this Charter, and
 - (ii) the signatures of the Speaker of the Students' Parliament, the General Secretary of the Students' Parliament, the Chief Election Commissioner, the Dean of Student Affairs, and the Director of the Institute.
- (b) Once this Charter is ratified, the Institute shall not unilaterally dissolve the Parliament, nor set aside any provision of this Charter, except by following the procedure as prescribed in Part VIII, Article I.

ARTICLE III INTERPRETATION

Section 1. Interpretation.

- (a) A question as to the interpretation of this Charter shall be decided by the Parliament and the Parliament may settle it by a Resolution of Procedure. A settled interpretation shall be recorded in the Parliamentary Archive and shall bind the Parliament until this Charter is amended or the interpretation is superseded by a later Resolution of Procedure.
- (b) A question as to the interpretation of this Charter arising in relation to the conduct of an election shall be decided by the Election Commission.

Section 2. Severability.

- (a) Where any provision of this Charter is found to be void, unenforceable, or contrary to the rules of the Institute or to the law, that provision alone shall cease to have effect, and every remaining provision shall continue in force so far as it can operate independently.

PART IX

APPENDIX

APPENDIX I

DEFINITIONS

Section 1. External Terms.

- (a) **The Institute.** The International Institute of Information Technology, Hyderabad, including its administration, faculty, staff, and governing bodies.
- (b) **Constituent.** Any student currently enrolled in a full-time academic programme at the Institute.
- (c) **Constituency.** The Election Commission shall divide Constituents into Constituencies based on factors such as their year or programme.
- (d) **Student Body, Club, or Special Interest Group.** A group of students with a designated purpose, enjoying official recognition as such from the Institute.
- (e) **Point of Contact.** An individual designated as the official liaison between a student council or body and a specific Institute administrative office, committee, or vendor.
- (f) **Positions of Responsibility.** Positions designated as such by the Institute or a Student Body from time to time. Where such a position is renamed, its successor position is intended; where it is abolished, the reference to it ceases to have effect.

APPENDIX II

OATHS

Section 1. Oath of Office. I, *Full Name*, do solemnly affirm that I will bear true faith and allegiance to the International Institute of Information Technology, Hyderabad; that I will faithfully and conscientiously discharge my duties as a Member of the Students' Parliament and as a student of this Institute; that I will uphold the ideals and values of this Institute in all my conduct and deliberations; and that I will do right to all manner of people without fear or favour, affection or ill-will.

Section 2. Oath of Secrecy. I, *Full Name*, do solemnly affirm that I shall not directly or indirectly communicate or reveal to any person, any confidential or personal matter that comes to my knowledge in the course of my duties as a Member of the Students' Parliament, except as may be required for the due discharge of my responsibilities as a Member.

Section 3. Oath of Leadership. I, *Full Name*, do solemnly affirm that I will carry out my responsibilities towards the Members of the Students' Parliament and the International Institute of Information Technology, Hyderabad community with fairness, diligence, and respect. I shall uphold transparency in my actions and communications with fellow Members and remain committed to ensuring the welfare of the student community.

APPENDIX III

AUTHORS

This Charter has been drafted by Vedant Kulkarni and Sanyam Gandhi.

The members of the Charter Drafting Panel are Anshul Krishnadas Bhagwat, Aviral Gupta, Kimaya Arora, Likhith Kanigolla, Neharika Rajesh, Pradeep Pal, Prithvi Karthik, Rishabh Patnaik, Sanyam Gandhi, Soham Vaishnav, Swati Yelamanchili, Vedant Kulkarni, and Veena Ramadas.

APPENDIX IV

AMENDMENTS

Each section of this appendix shall document every Resolution of Amendment passed by the Parliament as per the provisions of Part VIII, Article I, including but not limited to the title, date of passage, rationale for amendment, proposed amendment, and a count of votes for and against the Resolution.

APPENDIX V
RATIFICATION

This Charter, adopted by the Students' Parliament on the fifteenth day of August, 2026, is hereby ratified by the undersigned with their signatures.

Vedant Kulkarni
SPEAKER OF THE
STUDENTS' PARLIAMENT

Sanyam Gandhi
GENERAL SECRETARY OF THE
STUDENTS' PARLIAMENT

Aviral Gupta
CHIEF ELECTION
COMMISSIONER

Dr. Radhika Mamidi
DEAN OF
STUDENT AFFAIRS

Dr. Sandeep Shukla
DIRECTOR OF
THE INSTITUTE

